

Airplay support for Flickr videos

With the release of FlickrStacker 1.7.2 update, you can send Flickr videos to a second generation Apple TV

Gnome 3 fallback

Gnome 3 includes the old Gnome 2 UI as a fallback – just in case you're too cheap to buy a GPU

Bazaar

WD Scorpio Black WD7500BPKT

Black Beauty that doesn't cost an arm and a leg

We expect a lot from WD's Black Editions, because these drives command a hefty premium over other Blue and Green edition drives. The PCB is tightly integrated into the body – a flush fit – necessary to avoid damage due to external surfaces.

With an areal density of 375 GB per platter, WD7500BPKT follows the same two-platter design as the Scorpio Blue WD7500BPVT. With a 7200 RPM the WD7500BPKT is in a league of its own as far as notebook drives go.

In terms of speed, we were surprised to see it edging out most regular 3.5-inch drives in

all tests, but even the WD Black Edition 2 TB (WD2001FAS) in sequential read and write tests. It writes sequential data at an astounding 168.42 megabytes per second – which is faster than quite a few SSDs, and even faster than a 10,000 rpm Velociraptor.

In fact, it took just 41.7 seconds to display a 1 GB image file in our PhotoShop test, just two seconds longer than the WD 2 TB Black Edition. This is impressive for a hard drive, but SSDs are better – the S599 managed to complete this test in a mere 13.71 seconds. Per-



formance was excellent for a notebook drive, and if you want something faster, you'll probably have coughed up for an SSD. The minus was the heat produced; with two platters spinning at 7,200 rpm

the WD7500BPKT gets quite hot – temperatures can touch 60 degrees Centigrade.

The price is a jaw dropping ₹5,275, and we confirmed it at least three times! At this price, or near-about, it is a killer deal, since it's essentially cheaper than the Scorpio Blue WD7500BPVT, which is a much slower drive.

Michael Browne

Specifications

Capacity: 750 GB; Speed: 7,200 rpm; Cache: 16 MB; form factor: 2.5-inches; weight: 155 grams

Contact

Western Digital Corporation

Phone: 9880293193

Email: Srinivas.Sampangi@wdc.com

Web site: www.wdc.com

Price: ₹5,275

7.5/10

Features.....	7.5
Performance.....	7.5
Build.....	8.0
Value for money.....	8.0

Specifications

Capacity : 128 GB;
Interface : SATA 2;
Form Factor : 2.5-inch;
SSD Controller : Sand-
Force SF-1222

Contact

ADATA Technology

Phone: +886 2 82280886

Email: cheryl_chu@adata.com.tw

Web site: www.adata-group.com

Price: ₹14,140

6.5/10

Features.....	6.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	8.0
Value for money.....	5.0

ADATA S599

Lightning fast performance at a premium

Even as breakthroughs in magnetic recording push HDD storage outwards, it is a sad fact that hard drive speeds have failed to scale as much as their capacities. We reviewed a 128GB version of ADATA's SSD S599 drive, which for an SSD is still at the higher end of the spectrum.

Being an SSD, the ADATA S599 is noiseless, and consumes less energy than your usual hard disk drive. Additionally, it's lighter than a conventional hard drive – a mere 68 grams, and shockproof to a much greater degree as well. All this combined with the fact that it comes in a 2.5-inch form factor makes it quite a boon for laptop users. Desktop users aren't left behind either as

the S599 comes with a convenient 2.5- to 3.5-inch bracket.

During our tests the ADATA S599 performed quite well, with write speeds as high as 180 MBps, but averaging out to around 110 MBps. Read speeds were even more impressive – averaging around 180 MBps and peaking at over 200 MBps.

With Windows 7 installed on the SSD, we installed a number of common applications, and here are some results: WinRAR 4.00 Beta: Installed before we could see any progress bar, application launches instantly; LibreOf-

fice 3.3: Under 2 minutes; Microsoft Office 2010 Professional Plus: Full install in under 5 minutes, most applications launch in under a second; Firefox 3.6: Installs with only a short glimpse at the progress bar launched in under a second; Windows 7 itself took a mere 21 seconds to reach till the desktop from the boot menu.

This SSD is priced at ₹14,140, the ADATA S599 SSD is surely for early adopters. The performance benefits of SSD technology are currently more in access and seek times than in actual copying speeds.

Kshitij Sobti

